

Fact Sheet on Mixed Movements

January to June 2022

In the aftermath of the military coup of October 2021, UNHCR continued to address the risks of onward movements and incidents of trafficking among persons of concern. The rapid turnover in government staff and the postponement of state roll-out of the National Action Plan to Combat Human Trafficking have stalled some efforts to conduct capacity building and create information-sharing channels with government counterparts. Nevertheless, UNHCR has made significant progress toward the objectives of the **Mixed Movement Strategy**.

HIGHLIGHTS

- In February 2022, authorities in Khartoum began the practice of **roundups targeting foreigners living in Khartoum**, including persons of concern to UNHCR. The roundups have resulted in the arrest of hundreds of refugees and asylum-seekers in Khartoum, with heavy fines imposed on those who have expired or no documentation, and a risk of re-arrest for those who are released after paying fines. Refugee volunteers in Khartoum have been exercising additional caution in moving around Khartoum, due to their fear of arrest.
- According to volunteers, the **most popular onward movement route from Sudan continues to be to Libya**, although the most expensive. Due to the rising cost of living in Sudan, some refugees have noted intentions to go to South Sudan or Uganda to work towards affording onward movement into the Mediterranean route.
- In Khartoum, repeated protests have led to the **postponement and delay in implementing key outreach activities**. As such, the team has resorted to heavier reliance on social media such as Whatsapp and Telegram for two-way information sharing.
- In Gedaref, a **training with Law enforcement actors** was held on access to justice and remedies for VOT, judicial procedure and structures (national and international) for the prosecution of perpetrators.

KEY FIGURES

4,964

New arrivals in East Sudan

120

Victims of trafficking identified and referred for specialized services

9,423

Households reached with information on smuggling and onward movements in East Sudan

2,270

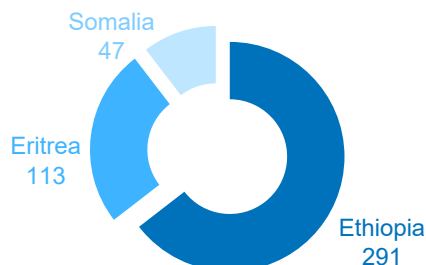
Households reached with information on smuggling and onward movements in Khartoum



Interview with victim of trafficking in Gedaref

During the first half of 2022, authorities in the Northern State have intercepted 1,371 individuals on the route leading from Sudan to Egypt and Libya¹. The majority are deported Sudanese nationals and noticeably, no Eritreans have so far been intercepted. In 2022, UNHCR will prioritize working with civil society organizations in order to ensure access to asylum for those intercepted, and to raise awareness on available support to persons on the move through Northern State.

In Gedaref, East Sudan interception breakdown was as follows: 291 from Ethiopia, 113 from Eritrean and 47 from Somalia.



Progress towards strategic objectives

Strategic Objective 1: Protection Based Solutions for persons affected by mixed flows

UAC center in Shagarab Camp

- **778 unaccompanied children** were hosted in the Unaccompanied Children reception center in Shagarab Refugee camp during the reporting period, of which 377 arrived in 2022. During the same period, **351 unaccompanied children spontaneously departed** the center. **28 children were transferred to alternative care arrangements** in the first half of 2022.
- UNHCR continues to work with children in the center to raise awareness on risks associated with onward movement and to find alternative care for children hosted in the center.
- UNHCR supported the **installation of solar panels** in the center to ensure uninterrupted access to energy.

Kassala Safehouse

- UNHCR supported a gender-segregated safe housing in Kassala, which hosted **66 (23 males, 43 females) victims of trafficking and GBV**, as they awaited trials of their perpetrators where they would appear as witnesses. Of these, **27 (41%)** arrived in the house between January and June 2022.

¹ Source: Source: Northern State Technical Committee on Migration and Counter-Trafficking. With thanks to The Sudanese Red Crescent Society for disseminating the data

Legal aid

- Sudanese Organization for Development (SOD) provided **legal aid support to 664 individuals** in Kassala AOR, including legal representation in courts. As a result of effective advocacy, **176 asylum seekers charged with illegal entry were released** and given access to COR registration.
- UNHCR Gedaref provided **directed assistance to 413 POCs** who were intercepted in various localities. The assistance ranged from court representations, psychological counselling, family reunification, medical assistance, and in-kind support

Resettlement and Complementary Pathways

- As part of ensuring effective CWC, UNHCR used Telegram and Whatsapp in Gedaref to **disseminate information to at-risk groups** and share credible information on higher education opportunities and other alternative pathways.

Strategic Objective 2: Capacity Building, Partnership and Coordination

Workshops

- **17 youth** engaged in two youth associations in Shagarab camps attended a one-day workshop organized by UNHCR on project management. After the workshop, each association received a vlogging kit (phone tripod with LED light) to help them document their achievements.

Trainings

- A **training on International Law**, including refugee law and combatting trafficking, was held in Port Sudan for **40 participants** from law enforcement, judiciary, prosecution, lawyers, NGO staff and the Humanitarian Aid Commission. The training aimed at strengthening their capacity to support persons of concern with their legal needs.
- In March 2022, UNHCR facilitated **two trainings to law enforcement officers** manning the camps and reception area under Gedaref AOR. The sessions brought together members of different security agencies to provide information on UNHCR's mandate, promote understanding of refugee rights, including when involved in mixed movements, and raise awareness on risks associated with onward movements.

MMWG-TWG

- **Coordination in Khartoum, Kassala and Gedaref states** continued in 2022, with the different technical working groups meeting to share updates, and plan joint activities and advocacy.
 - Khartoum Technical Working Group convened three times.
 - East Sudan Migration Working Group in Kassala convened three times.
 - Gedaref Mixed Migration Working Group convened monthly

Strategic Objective 3: Information Management, Advocacy & Awareness Raising

- UNHCR Gedaref organized a **roundtable discussion** with the Judiciary, Director of Public Prosecution, police, immigration officers and prison officials to discuss issues relating to mixed movements. The session resulted in a joint plan of action with identified focal points to enable expedited information sharing and response by different actors.

Awareness raising

- **Three Family Reunification sensitization sessions** were conducted for **15 staff of key government and NGO stakeholders** in Kassala AOR to better enable identification of individuals with family reunification needs.

Telling the Real Story

- TRS Khartoum has continued the **sports activities** which started in 2021, using a new location in AlDeem. The new location hosts refugee men and women to play football and volleyball every weekend. The project aims at providing a safe space to refugees through sports, empowering refugees to monitor the project and identifying individuals with specific needs.
- For new arrivals in Shagarab camps, **three animation videos in Tigrinya** were produced to highlight available services.
- As part of the empowerment efforts under TRS, a **one-day workshop on digital safety** was held for 14 refugee volunteers in Shagarab camp.
- To foster cohesion, UNHCR Khashm El Girba coordinated **two football tournaments** in Abuda and Shagarab I camps. Teams from host and refugee communities participated in the tournaments and players were provided with clothing kits, footballs and nets. In addition to the players, thousands of fans attended the tournaments and TRS project volunteers took the opportunity to conduct awareness-raising on the risk of onward movement.
- In Gedaref, **21 volunteers were recruited and trained** in Um Rakuba and Tunaydba camps. The network of volunteers is instrumental in information dissemination through door-to-door campaigns and facilitating FGDs.

World Refugee Day

Under the global theme, **“Everyone has the right to seek safety”**, UNHCR in Khashm El Girba worked closely with the refugee community who organized a cultural exhibition to showcase the diversity of refugees in the area. Refugees working in different agencies’ livelihood projects attended and displayed their different cultural marks.

In Khartoum, refugee volunteers were provided a budget to develop and implement a celebration event. With UNHCR support, they were able to showcase and their develop their project management skills through a full-day event which included drama sketches, refugee art exhibition, and traditional coffee ceremonies with approximately 200 refugees in attendance.

Identified opportunities, gaps, and needs

- Training to law enforcement officials has so far yielded in **expedited referrals** to UNHCR for intercepted refugees and asylum-seekers.
- The **encampment policy of Sudan** continues to prompt refugees to leave camps with the help of smugglers, making them vulnerable to abuse.
- Despite being scheduled for early 2022, state roll-out of the **National Committee to Combat Human Trafficking remains pending**.
- **Continuous turnover in the staff of key government counterparts** raises challenges in cementing protection-sensitive mechanisms in the national system, whereby stakeholders need continuous training and support.
- Given the **recent changes in the political and socioeconomic situation in Sudan**, it is recommended to supplement existing knowledge on trafficking with new research. UNHCR will prioritize resource mobilization into research opportunities.